

● BRANDBOOK



tareeq.

The brand system that points a 16-year-old in MENA toward the work that's been waiting. Tokens, type, motion, and voice — one source of truth.

What Tareeq *stands for*.

Tareeq (طريق) means *path*. It's a career discovery compass for 16-to-22-year-olds across MENA and Muslim-majority regions — built to turn an assessment into a path the user actually walks.

Who we serve

Young people in the moment they're being asked to choose — major, specialty, scholarship, first job — without enough light to choose well. Tareeq's audience is mid-teen to early-twenties, in a region where the family is part of the decision.

What we believe

People with similar curiosity patterns end up in similar kinds of work. The path you're built for isn't a job title — it's a cluster you're already moving toward. Our job is to draw it for you.

What we are

A guided pathway app. Assessment → CORE compass → local opportunities → mentor pairing → weekly next step. The arc matters as much as the test.

What we are not

Not a personality quiz. Not a job board. Not a chatbot. Not a grade. We point a direction; the user chooses the destination.

The one-line positioning

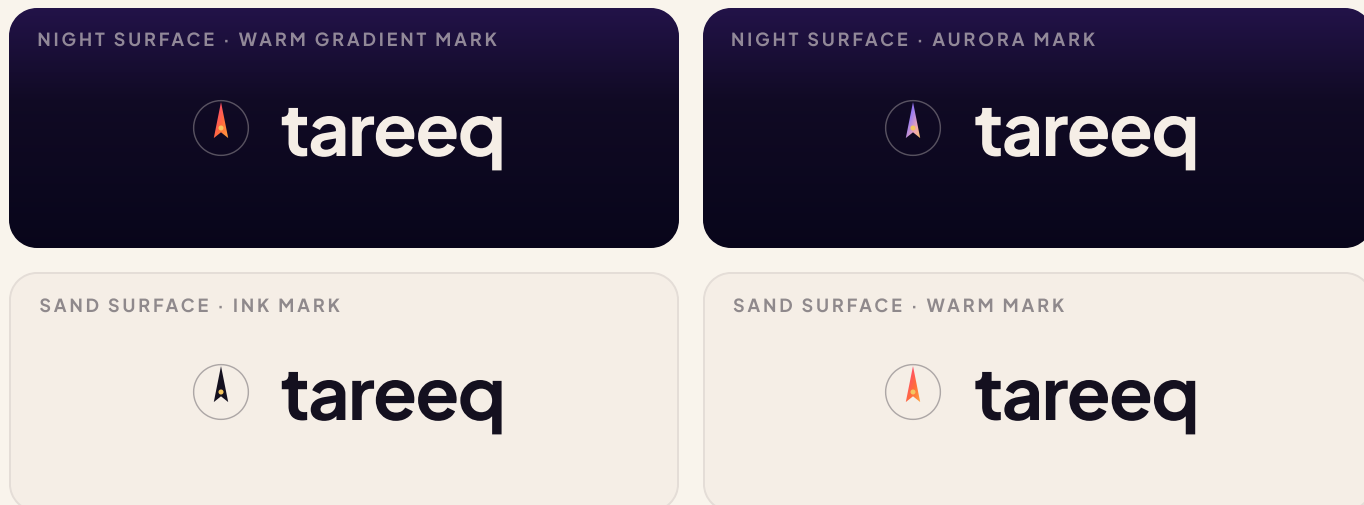
*A **compass**, not a GPS.*

Tareeq points the direction. The user chooses the destination. This single line is the test that every product, marketing, and editorial decision must pass.

02 The *mark*.

Two parts: the **mark** (a north-pointing arrow inside a horizon ring, with a gold center) and the **wordmark** (Plus Jakarta Sans, ExtraBold, lowercase, letterspacing -0.025em). The mark is always paired with the wordmark unless used as an app icon or favicon.

Primary lockups



Clearspace & minimum size

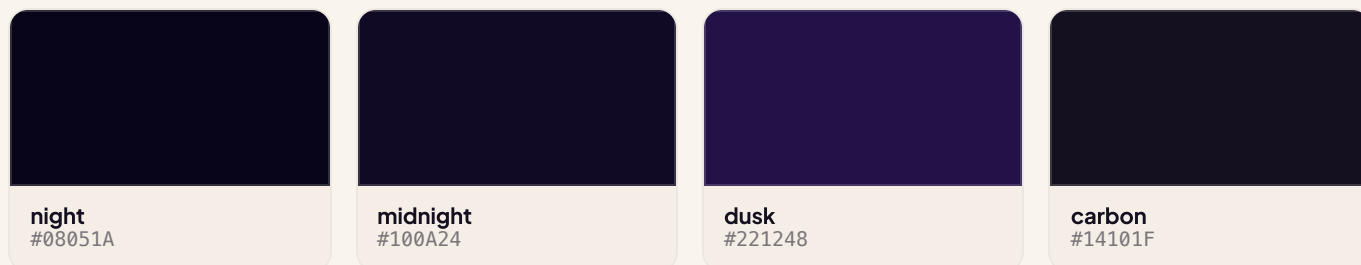
Clearspace = the full height of the mark on every side of the lockup. Minimum size: 18px mark for screen, 14mm for print. Below these sizes use the mark alone. The mark is never re-drawn, re-colored outside the approved gradient palette, or rotated.

03 The *palette*.

COLOR SYSTEM

Four working surfaces (**night**, **midnight**, **dusk**, **sand**), one violet family for atmosphere, a warm gradient for primary action, and gold as the signature accent. The night triplet sets the contemplative canvas; warm gradient is the focal flourish that pulls the eye.

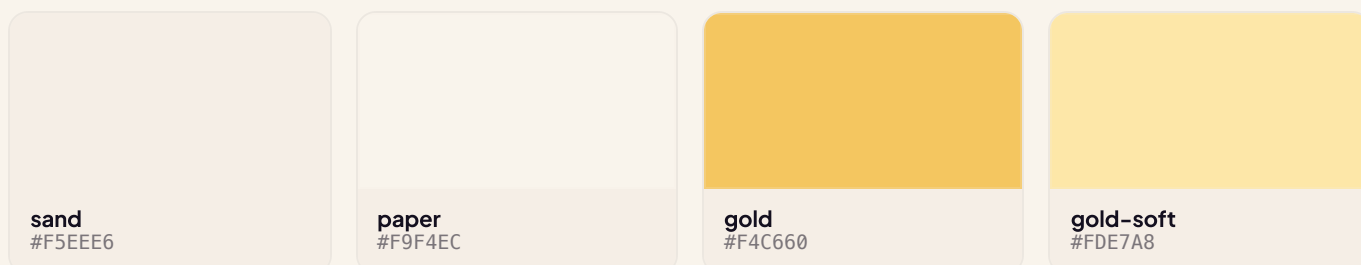
Night surfaces



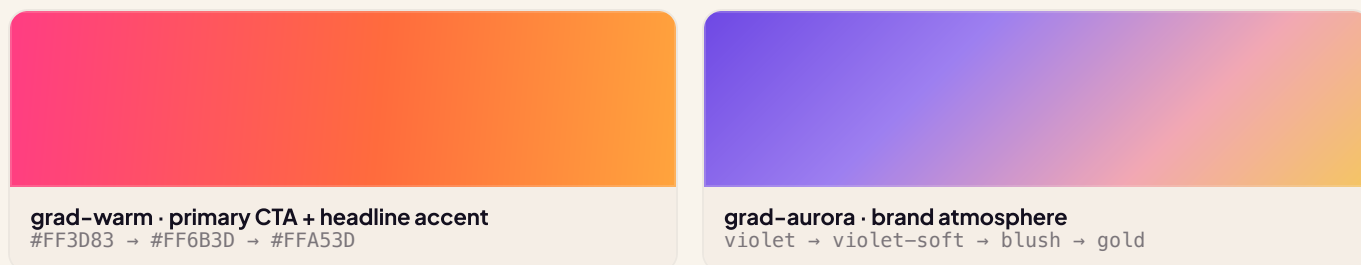
Violet family



Light surfaces & accents



Gradients — the action language



04 The *type system*.

TYPOGRAPHY

Two faces, used for two jobs. **Fraunces** (variable — `SOFT` and `opsz` axes) is the editorial voice: chunky display italic for the *warm-gradient* accent words. **Plus Jakarta Sans** is the working voice: body, UI, eyebrows, meta. No third family.

Display & hero

DISPLAY	Find the work that's been <i>waiting.</i>	Fraunces 500 / italic accent SOFT 100, opsz 144 38–96px clamp
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HERO	A quiet <i>contract.</i>	Fraunces 600 SOFT 80, opsz 144 28–34px
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Working voice

BODY	Tareeq points the direction. The user still chooses the destination — and that line is the test every product decision passes.	Plus Jakarta Sans 400 14px / 1.55
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BODY SM	Tap to continue · ~12 min · Free · Stays on your device.	Plus Jakarta Sans 400 12px / 1.5
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EYEBROW	A CAREER COMPASS	Plus Jakarta Sans 700 10px / 0.18em tracking
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MONO	/intro · /contract · /q/[index]	ui-monospace 12px paths & tokens
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Voice rules baked into type

- Sentence-case all headings — never Title Case.
- Curly quotes (‘ ’), em-dashes (—), middle-dot separators (·) — never the straight or hyphen equivalents.
- The italic display accent is reserved for the **one word** the eye should land on. Don't accent more than one phrase per line.

05 The *compass*.

SIGNATURE MECHANIC

The compass is Tareeq's signature visual. Four quadrants for the CORE pillars — **C**uriosities, **O**perations, **R**ewards, **E**cosystems — fill with the warm gradient as the user answers questions in each. The active quadrant pulses with a warm-gradient stroke. Center holds the overall percentage.



The pillars

- **C · Curiosities** — what pulls your attention.
- **O · Operations** — how you actually work.
- **R · Rewards** — what actually moves you.
- **E · Ecosystems** — where you thrive.

Rules

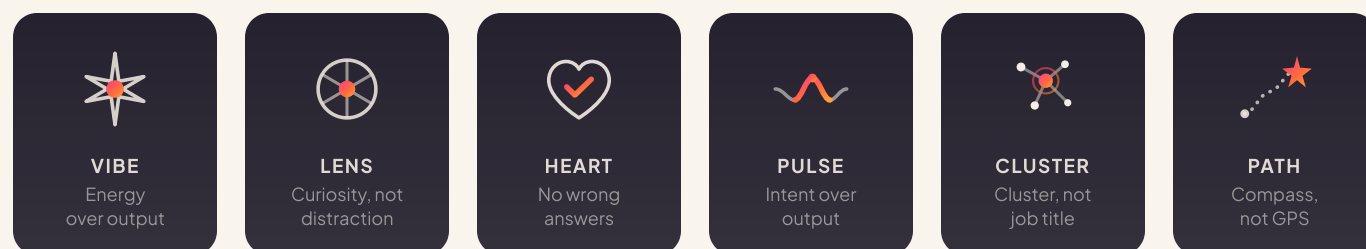
- Fill is always the **warm gradient**. Never solid orange.
- The active quadrant ring uses the same warm gradient at 2px.
- Letters are always C·O·R·E clockwise from top.
- Fill values tween — they never snap.

The compass replaces the linear progress bar found in every other career app. It earns its real estate by encoding both *how far* and *which way* — which axis is forming, not just how many questions are done.

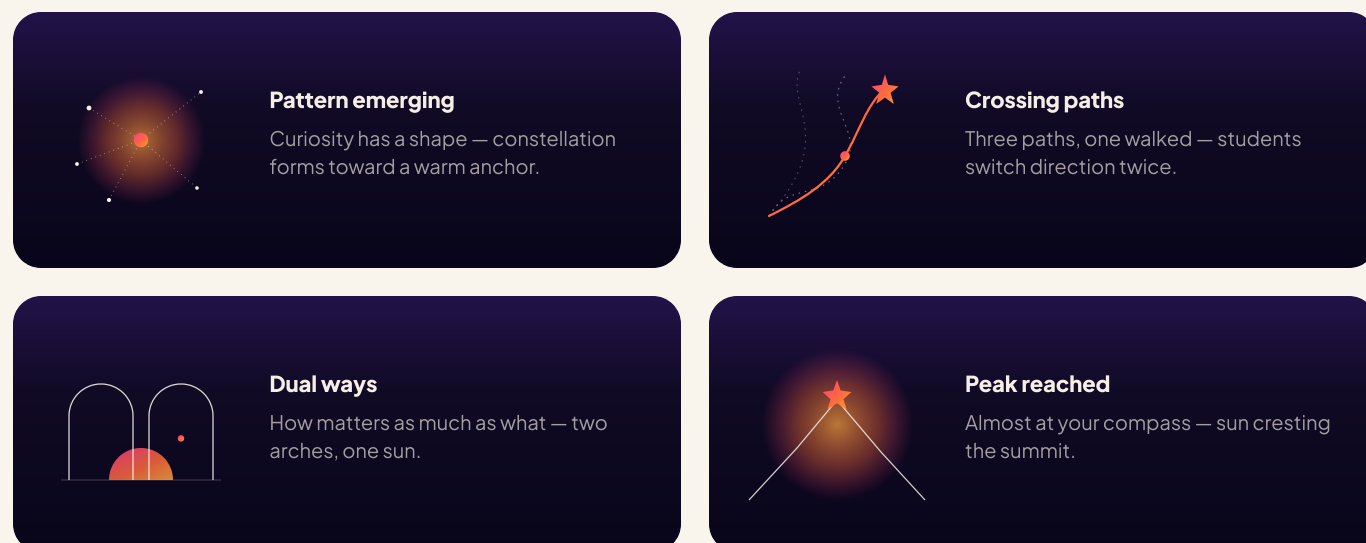
Icons & *illustrations*.

Two illustration languages, one rule: hairline cream strokes with a single warm-gradient signature flourish per mark. Icons live inside glass tiles on the night surface; illustrations live inside violet glass plates on the night sheet.

Contract icons (32×32)



Interstitial scenes (240×240)



Kai @ the voice.

Kai is the guide — never a teacher, never a coach, never a mascot. Kai shows up at /intro, narrates the question screens, and reappears on result. The voice is the same whether it's written, spoken in EN, or spoken in AR.

Voice — the five attributes

- **Warm**, low-mid register. Older sibling, not parent.
- **Grounded**. Calm. Not motivational. Not aspirational.
- **Curious**. The compass is real to Kai too.
- **Editorial**. Sentences breathe. Pauses matter.
- **MENA-fluent**. Arabic-first viability without performance.

The line that sets the voice

"Think of me as a filter for all the noise. We're after your Energy Flows — the things that pull you in and make time disappear. Pick what you'd actually do · not what you think you should."

On /intro. Read this aloud — every other line of Kai should sit in the same register.

Do · Don't

DO

"A quiet contract."

Editorial restraint. Italic accent on one word. Period.

DON'T

"Get Ready to Find Your TRUE Purpose!"

Title case. All caps. Exclamation. Marketing affect.

DO

"Pick what you'd actually do."

Permissioning, plain, second-person, contraction kept.

DON'T

"Click the answer that resonates with your authentic self."

Therapy-speak. Loanwords from wellness apps.

Motion principles

Motion clarifies hierarchy. It is not decoration. Every animation in Tareeq either **reveals state** (e.g. compass arc growing) or **stages information** (e.g. contract items landing one beat at a time). Never both for the same element.

Easing

`cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.7, 0.2, 1)`

Calligraphic landing. Fast start, gentle settle. Used for content reveals.

Duration

`fast 120 · base 200 · slow 320 · reveal 480 · sheet 720`

Never linger past reveal-duration without a reason.

Stagger

`~180ms between siblings`

Slow enough to read each. Fast enough to feel intentional.

Reduced motion

All keyframes collapse to instant under `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce`. The hook honors it; designers must not bypass it.

Surface vocabulary

SURFACE-NIGHT

The default canvas. Night gradient with a top-centered violet bloom (the "spotlight from above"). Used for the entire assessment flow.

SURFACE-SAND

The bright surface. Used for celebration beats and print documents. Carries the same atmosphere via subtle warm and violet radials.

GLASS-CARD

Translucent content panels — resume banner, contract rows, answer cards. Blur 16px · gradient fill 10→4% · 1px sand border at 14%.

GLASS-TILE

Smaller variant for interactive chips and icons — back button, compass step nodes, mute pill. Blur 12px · gradient fill 14→6%.

Quick *reference.*

Everything you need to brief a freelancer, partner, or new designer in one page. Tokens, spacing, and links to the live source.

Tokens

```
--night #08051A
--midnight #100A24
--dusk #221248
--carbon #14101F
--sand #F5EEE6 · --paper #F9F4EC
--violet #6E48E4 · --violet-soft #9D7FF0
--gold #F4C660
--grad-warm 95deg #FF3D83→#FF6B3D→#FFA53D
```

Typography

```
Display · Fraunces 500 italic
      SOFT 100, opsz 144
Hero · Fraunces 600 SOFT 80
Body · Plus Jakarta 400 / 14px
Eyebrow · Plus Jakarta 700 / 10px
      tracking 0.18em uppercase
```

Spacing rhythm

```
Card radius · 14–28px
Tile radius · 12px
Pill radius · 9999px
Page gutters · 20px mobile / 0.7in print
Stagger step · 180ms
Reveal duration · 480–720ms
```

Voice rules

Sentence case. Curly quotes. Em-dashes and middle-dots (.). No exclamation marks. One italic accent per line. Confident, energetic, grounded — never aspirational.

Live source of truth

- Design tokens · [app/globals.css](#) + [tailwind.config.ts](#)
- Component vocabulary · [components/assessment/](#), [components/brand/](#)
- Icon system · [components/brand/ContractIcons.tsx](#), [InterstitialScenes.tsx](#)
- Production · [tareeq-gray.vercel.app](#)

The brandbook in one rule

The night surface is the canvas. The warm gradient is the action. Sand is the rest. Italic Fraunces is the voice. Everything else serves these four.